MATTHEW O'LEARY

Print Production Lead | Magazines, Catalogs & Publishing

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Print production leader with 20+ years managing magazines, 800+ page national retail catalogs, books, and consumer packaging. Currently Designer & Production Manager for California magazine, taking each issue from layout through press with Quad. Build templates, file standards, and automated workflows that keep complex publications consistent and press-ready.

CORE SKILLS

- Production management: Schedules and page flow; editorial, design, and photo coordination; approval cycles; post-press archiving.
- Prepress and print quality: PDF/X preflight; CMYK and Pantone color; image correction; color separations; imposition; proofing and press checks.
- InDesign systems and automation: Templates; parent pages; paragraph, character, and GREP styles; Find/Change; Data Merge; ExtendScript.
- Publishing and packaging: Magazines; retail catalogs; books; multilingual curriculum; accessible PDFs; packaging mechanicals and labels.
- Printer and vendor coordination: Offset, digital, screen, and large-format printing; file delivery; proof approval; quality control.
- Software: Adobe InDesign, Illustrator, Photoshop, Acrobat Pro; Jira, Trello, Airtable; Figma; Microsoft Office; ChatGPT, Claude.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Designer & Production Manager | *California* Magazine

Aug 2026 – Present | Cal Alumni Association | Remote, Contract

- Own magazine production from layout through press: page flow, ad preflight, image placement, and final files for editorial, advertising, and inserts.
- Manage the printer relationship with Quad, from file delivery and proof approval to press coordination, on a fixed publication schedule.
- Coordinate layout and proof reviews with the Creative Director and Managing Editor. Built the Fall 2026 class notes, obituaries, and masthead from scratch.

Production Consultant & Designer | Matt O'Leary Design

2010 – Present | Santa Cruz, CA

- Manage production for packaging, publishing, and collateral clients, coordinating print vendors from brief through delivery.
- Develop FDA-compliant packaging mechanicals and product labels.
- Create screen-print color separations for clients including O'Neill Surf Shop.
- Build tiled large-format files for booths, building drapes, and bus wraps.

Production Support Specialist | OBXtek
Dec 2024 – Oct 2025 | Defense Language Institute contract | Monterey, CA

- Produced long-form foreign-language curriculum in InDesign.
- Standardized templates for 14+ languages and tracked work in Airtable.
- Performed QC and prepared accessible PDFs for government curriculum.

Senior Designer | Wiser Solutions, Axway, Kiteworks
2014 – 2023 | Remote and Palo Alto, CA

- Built template-driven systems for global print and digital campaigns at Axway; maintained design systems and handoffs at Wiser Solutions and Kiteworks.

Creative Lead | FastPencil
Oct 2011 – May 2014 | Campbell, CA

- Led design and production for 50+ book interiors and covers a year, building complete templates and style hierarchies.
- Delivered files to printers, KDP, and IngramSpark with high first-pass rates.

Print Production Manager | McDill Associates
Sep 2008 – Nov 2011 | Soquel, CA

- Managed print production and designed packaging for national brands including Costco, Martinelli's, and Rainbow Light.
- Built dielines, spot-color separations, and regulated copy for multi-SKU packaging; coordinated printers and paper suppliers.
- Produced wayfinding and large-format signage for trade shows like PMA.

Prepress Manager | West Marine
Jan 2002 – Aug 2008 | Watsonville, CA

- Managed prepress for 800+ page national retail catalogs, including preflight, color management, pagination, imposition, and proofing.
- Coordinated print vendors and ran press checks at Midwest printers.

Co-founder | The Juice Surf Magazine
1994 – 2000 | Santa Cruz, CA

- Co-founded and ran an independent quarterly surf magazine, producing about 20 issues from editorial through print.

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz
Coursework in Art, Design & Visual Studies